

Uncertain authorization outcomes

When to use this guide

A missing timely response does not establish failure. A downstream authorization may have completed while its acknowledgement was lost. Investigate the exact attempt before proposing another request, cancellation or release.

The Gateway Owner owns confirmation recovery. Payment Operations records what is known, what is unknown and whether any active hold is independently confirmed. This guide addresses uncertain authorization outcomes, not refund completion.

Document control	Value
Key / version	RB-102 / 1.0.0
Document ID	837bf69f-1ea7-4cc6-8d51-2e5ef19cfabd
Owner	Gateway Owner
Tenant ID	8b860d80-d17f-4e6b-8c48-af35f26a4d61
Status / effective	APPROVED / 2026-10-01
Approver	Knowledge Approver (fictional role)
Scope	authorization, release
Risks / sources	R02, R03, R09, R19 / E02, E03, E05, E10, E11

Synthetic notice: All systems, records, roles and amounts are fictional. Guidance is advisory and never executes an action.

Build a bounded outcome timeline

Identity before elapsed time

Start with E02: tenant, intent, request, idempotency key and canonical payload identity. Keep attempts separate even if their display titles match. Preserve source event time, received time and collection time; order within a source by its supported version/sequence, not transport arrival.

Obtain E03 for each affected request and E05 for any linked hold. Record explicit approval/decline and remaining held amount separately. E05 can confirm a hold without explaining why a local response was missing. Missing E05 does not prove that no hold exists. Compare E10's effective deadline with the source event time. If that rule or E11 clock uncertainty is absent, do not assert overdue or expired.

Outcome branches

Evidence available	Investigation direction
Correlated approval	Treat that attempt as approved; inspect linked hold before any recovery
Correlated explicit decline	Retain the decline; check other attempts before considering another submission
No final correlated response	Keep UNKNOWN; request source recovery rather than retrying blindly
Conflicting final records	Preserve both IDs/versions; investigate identity and mapping with owners

Check negative evidence scope: a complete empty E03 query may use the wrong operation/window or lack retained history. An acknowledgement for a different request is not confirmation for this attempt. Two holds do not establish two confirmed captures; compare lifecycle stages before calling an outcome duplicate.

Recovery must wait for a known boundary

Conditional action review

Do not advise a new-key retry while a prior outcome remains unknown. PL-102 requires original-operation confirmation and idempotency review. A confirmed approval may need a separately authorized hold-release procedure if the intent was cancelled; RB-105 distinguishes release from refund of captured units. A confirmed decline may support a bounded next diagnostic step, but does not authorize bypassing a card condition or repeating a changed payload under one key.

Confirmation package

Ask the Gateway Owner for the exact request's final response, linked hold record, applicable deadline and source coverage. Include the earliest/latest retained versions and any clock uncertainty. If unavailable, record the attempted scope and owner checkpoint without inventing a completion time.

After separately authorized recovery, verify both the original attempt and any new operation with distinct correlated acknowledgements. Rollback of local configuration cannot undo an approved authorization; any hold release remains a separate operation with its own authority and confirmation.

Product limit and closure

Current MCP provides only aggregate E01 errors. Item-level records referenced here are future source requirements. Close with confirmed bounded outcome or explicitly unresolved uncertainty; degraded/empty evidence keeps Q6 LOW/null report fields.

Related guidance and revision

Related documents: RB-103, RB-105, PL-102, PL-103.

Version 1.0.0, effective 2026-10-01. Initial independent risk-derived issue. Review cadence: annual, or before a material domain/source/control change.